Smart Therapist Matching

A transparent, availability-aware way to help people choose a therapist with **greater confidence**.

Reduce uncertainty and friction from discovery to first session.

Start with explainable, rules-based matching and validate impact.

We learn from your feedback — not outcomes — to improve the experience.

Proposed approach, assumptions and weights to validate.



Three Hypotheses Worth Validating Before Building

Test early. Learn fast. Build what matters.

01 Fit uncertainty

Profiles and filters may not help users judge relevance, leading to hesitation and low confidence.

Validate by
5-8 exploratory interviews and funnel analysis.

02 Availability mismatch

Promising profiles may not fit actual schedules, language, or eligibility, causing wasted effort and abandonment.

Validate by
Zero-result searches, stale profiles, time-to-book, and booking abandonment.

03 Poor-fit recovery

After the first session, users may struggle to share feedback or switch, leading to silent drop-off and friction.

Validate by
Optional post-session feedback, interviews, and switching patterns.

Prioritize after validation

Use frequency × severity × evidence to focus on the highest-impact opportunities.
These are hypotheses, not established facts.

Note: Proposed approach; assumptions and weights to validate.

Explainable Rules-Based Matching Model

Filter for feasibility. Rank for stated fit. Explain the result.

01 Filter for feasibility

Apply hard constraints to ensure eligibility, availability, and acces.
No silent relaxation.

Inputs we consider

- Concern or goal
- Preferred language
- Preferred counselling approach
- Availability
- Access needs
- Explicit preferences

02 Rank for fit

Score and rank using transparent weights.

40% Concern / expertise fit

25% Approach & preferences

20% Schedule fit

15% Language & other preferences

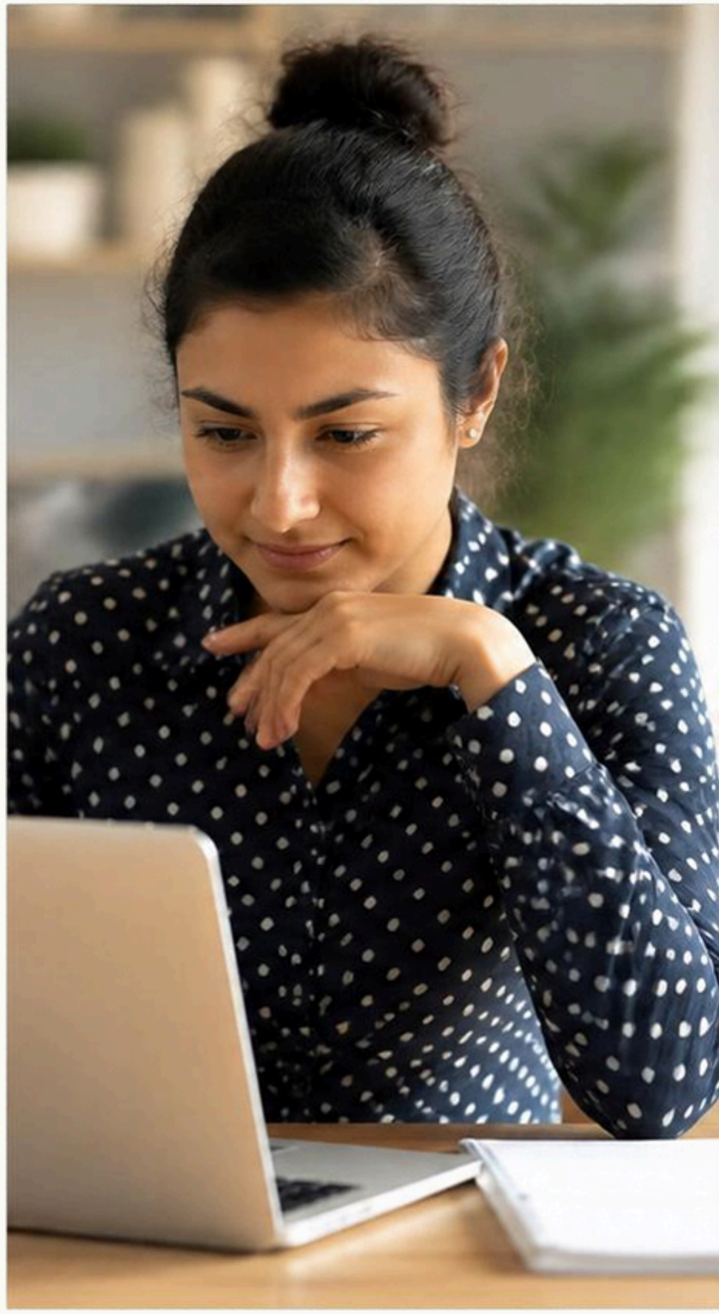
Normalize scores.

Missing inputs ≠ negative.

03 Explain and empower

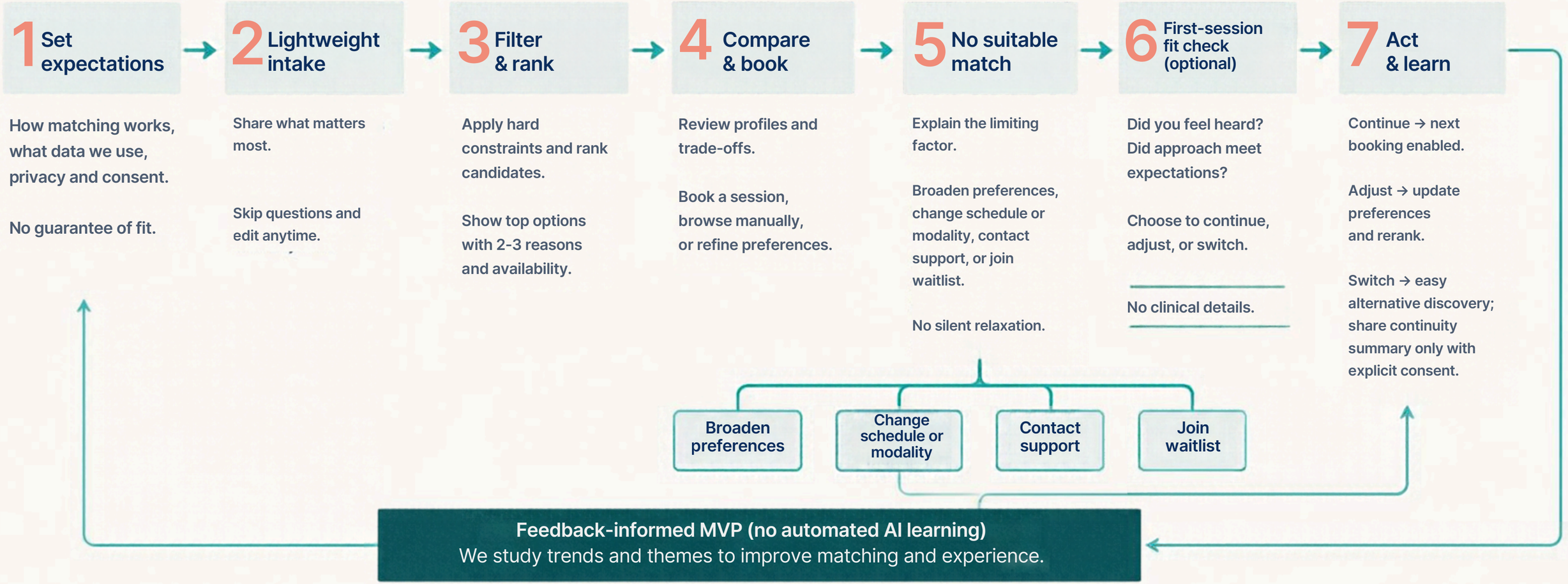
Show 2-3 grounded reasons, real availability, and trade-offs.
Let users edit preferences and explore close matches.
Matches are options, not predictions.

Proposed approach; assumptions and weights to validate.



Complete User Journey (1–7) with Recovery and Feedback Loop

Transparent matching, informed choices, and continuous improvement.
No guarantee of fit. Your data, your consent.



Note: Proposed approach; assumptions and weights to validate.

MVP Priorities, Metrics, and Guardrails

Ship a focused MVP, measure what matters, and protect user trust.

MVP PRIORITIES

P0

Short intake
Structured verified therapist profiles
Fresh availability
Hard-constraint filtering
Explanable weighted ranking
Compare/manual browse
No-match recovery
Optional fit check
Easy switch
Event instrumentation + privacy controls

P1

Preference re-ranking
Consented continuity summary
Funnel and guardrail dashboards
Improved ranking with reliable data

Later: ML/personalisation when scale, data quality, governance, and fairness justify.

KEY METRICS

Matching Effectiveness

Recommended-therapist booking conversion = (users booking recommended therapist) / (users shown recommendations)
Time from discovery start to booking
First-session attendance rate
Perceived fit = (positive-fit respondents) / (respondents answering), always reported with response rate

Retention / Continuity

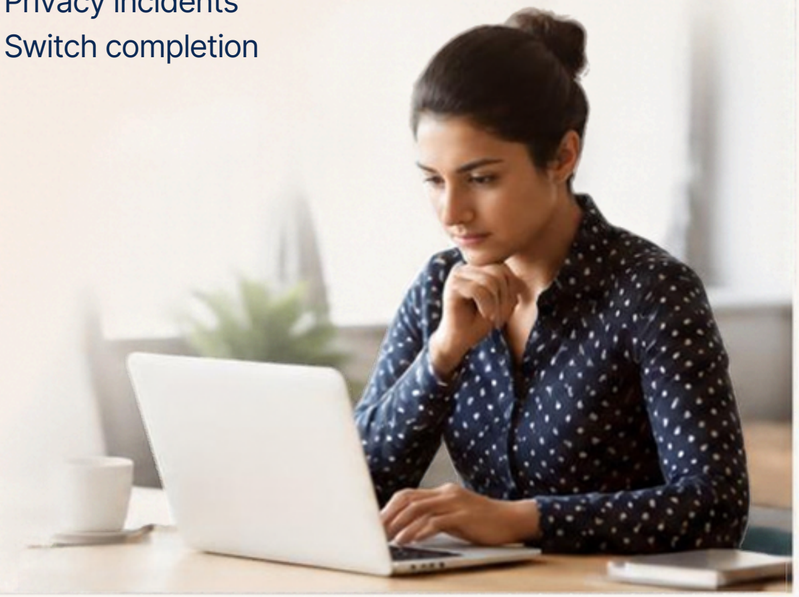
Attended second session within 30 days / first-session attendees with 30-day window; switching diagnostic, not failure

Therapy Outcomes (clinical)

Change baseline to follow-up on validated measure, only with clinical oversight & consent
Report completion and missingness
Do not equate retention with clinical success

GUARDRAILS

No-match rate
Wait/time-to-appointment
Availability accuracy
Cancellations/no-shows
Complaints
Relevant subgroup disparities
Privacy incidents
Switch completion



Note: Proposed approach; assumptions and weights to validate.

Experiment Plan, Decision Rule, Open Questions & Closing Recommendation

A measured path to launch and learn.

Experiment plan

Audit data and map the current funnel
Validate assumptions with research
Pilot rules-based matching
Measure outcomes with guardrails
Iterate; add complexity only if it helps

Decision rule

Expand if matching effectiveness
and perceived fit improve vs baseline
and guardrails remain acceptable
Pause if errors, no-match, complaints,
privacy risk, or disparities worsen
Set thresholds after baseline measurement

Open questions

Which profile and availability fields are reliable?
What funnel events exist?
How do service eligibility constraints vary?
Which clinical outcome and governance apply?
What consent and privacy rules apply?

Closing recommendation

Launch a transparent, rules-based MVP that helps users make informed choices, provides clear recovery paths, and measures fit—not just clicks or retention. Build complexity only when evidence warrants it.

Note: Proposed approach; assumptions and weights to validate.

